

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 9

WETLANDS - 2

IMPORTANCE OF WETLANDS

1. Wetlands are very rich in biodiversity.
2. Wetlands are habitat to aquatic flora and fauna, numerous species of native and migratory birds.
3. They carry out water purification, filtration of sediments and nutrients from surface water.
4. They help in ground water recharging.
5. Wetlands are important carbon sinks.
6. Wetlands play an important role in flood mitigation.
7. Wetlands are important tourist destinations.
8. We get many resources from wetlands including fish and shellfish (Shrimp), several fruits and timber.
9. Wetlands act as riparian buffer.

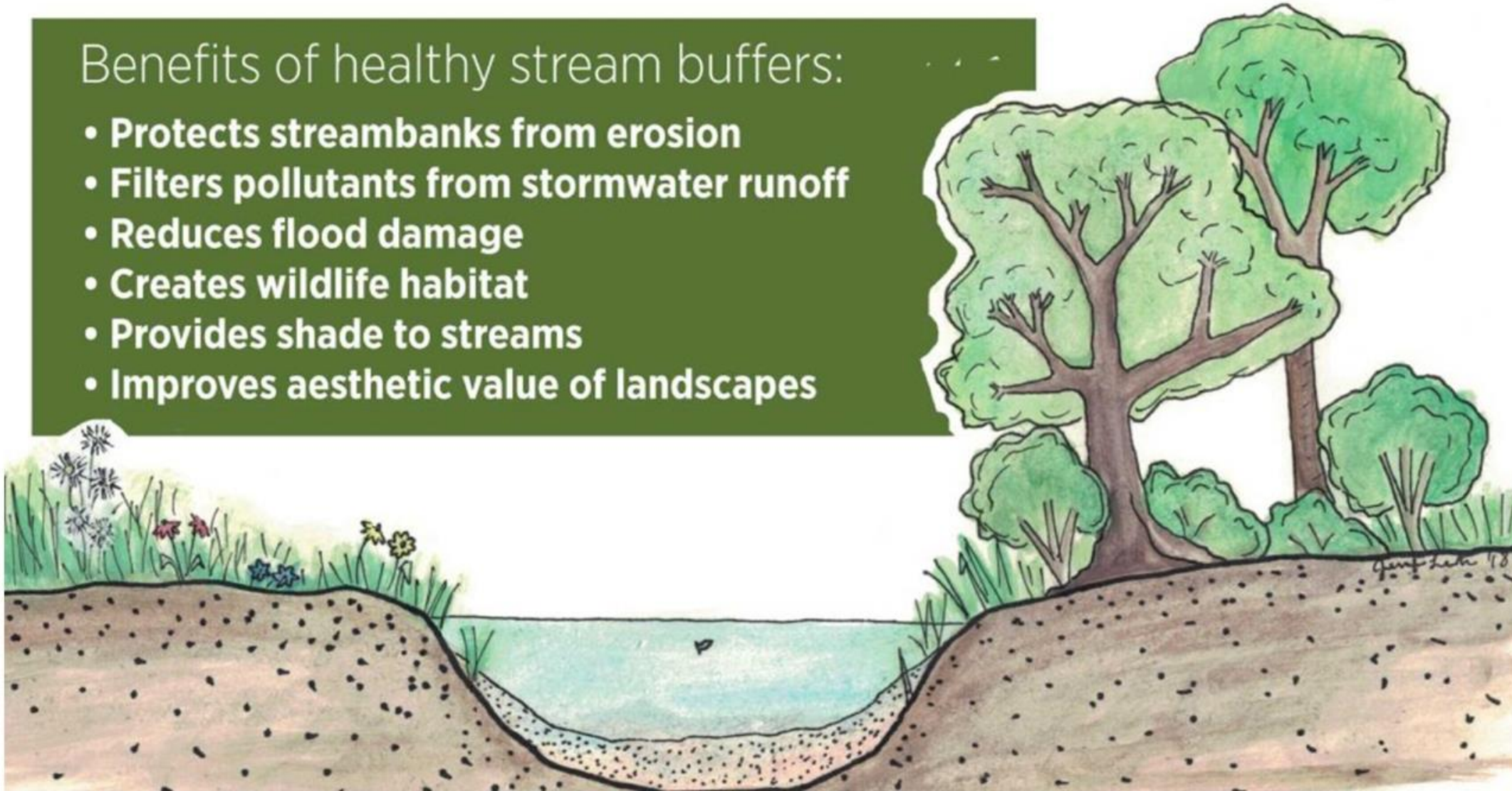
RIPARIAN BUFFER

- Riparian Buffers are wetlands either occurring naturally or made by humans close to the water body. They protect the water body from surface run-off.
- Riparian buffer acts as a natural filter which absorbs the contaminants or sediments from the surface run-off and protects the water body from pollution.



Benefits of healthy stream buffers:

- **Protects streambanks from erosion**
- **Filters pollutants from stormwater runoff**
- **Reduces flood damage**
- **Creates wildlife habitat**
- **Provides shade to streams**
- **Improves aesthetic value of landscapes**



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